



Gingivectomy

Purpose: Surgical removal of excess gum tissue to treat gum disease or improve aesthetics.

First 24 Hours:

- Avoid disturbing the surgical area.
- Do not rinse, spit, or use a straw.
- Keep head elevated while resting.

Pain & Swelling:

- Mild discomfort and swelling are normal.
- Take prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs to the cheek for 20 minutes on/off for the first 4–6 hours.

Bleeding:

- Slight bleeding or pink saliva is normal for 1–2 days.
- Apply gentle pressure with gauze if bleeding increases.

Oral Hygiene:

- Avoid brushing the surgical site for 1–2 weeks or until cleared by your dentist.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinse if provided.
- Brush and floss other areas normally.

Diet:

- Soft foods for several days.
- Avoid spicy, crunchy, or hot foods that could irritate healing tissue.

Follow-Up:

- Stitches may dissolve or require removal in 1–2 weeks.
- Contact the office if swelling worsens, pain increases, or bleeding persists beyond 48 hours.